Sebastian Kolbusz

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Senior Frontend Engineer - Performance-First Web, Full-Stack Delivery

SUMMARY

Senior Frontend Engineer who picks the stack for the problem, not the trend. Six years in-house on a business-critical point of sale (POS) SaaS platform in TypeScript, React and GraphQL, where I cut the production bundle by 50% and mentored the team on Apollo Client. Since 2026 I run my own web studio: most sites ship as Astro with small Svelte or React islands, because most of the web does not need a client-side app; React and Next.js come in where the product really is an application. I build with AI agents (Claude Code, Codex) and let automated checks, not trust, decide when work is done. Building websites since 2016.

SKILLS

Languages: JavaScript (ESNext), TypeScript, HTML5, CSS3, SCSS, PHP, SQL
Frontend: Astro, Svelte, React, Next.js, Apollo Client, Redux, Tailwind CSS, CSS Modules, Styled-components, Leaflet, ApexCharts, Responsive Mobile-First Design
Backend & APIs: Node.js, Payload CMS (multi-tenant), GraphQL, REST APIs, Laravel, PostgreSQL, MySQL, SQLite, MongoDB
Infrastructure: Cloudflare Workers and R2, Docker, Dokploy, VPS administration, CI/CD, Git, npm publishing, Webpack, Vite
Testing & Quality: Jest, React Testing Library, Cypress, Playwright, visual regression testing, quality gates
AI-Assisted Development: Claude Code, Codex, MCP servers, spec-driven development, ADRs
Practices: Web Performance Optimization, accessibility (WCAG), SEO, UI/UX, code review, technical mentorship, Scrum/Agile

WORK EXPERIENCE

stronypodhale.pl (own web studio) | Zakopane, Poland / Remote 01/2026 - Present
Founder, Full-Stack Engineer

- **Astro by Default:** Ship content sites as static or SSR Astro on Cloudflare Workers with minimal client-side JavaScript, adding Svelte islands only where a page needs interaction (stronypodhale.pl, wellezza.pl, kafgarage.pl, PawDrive storefront).
- **React Where It Fits:** Use React and Next.js for application-shaped work - Payload CMS admin UI, custom plugins and the Next.js sites zakofy.com and yourkrakowtravel.com.
- **Multi-Tenant Network:** Architected one Payload CMS on PostgreSQL serving four live travel sites, each an Astro SSR app on its own domain, with a shared rendering core, R2 media and per-tenant deploy hooks; zero third-party requests, so no cookie banner.
- **AI-Assisted Delivery:** Claude Code and Codex write most of the code under my direction and review; output is accepted by machines, not by eye - unused CMS blocks fail compilation, refactors are proven by byte-identical rendered HTML, and kafgarage.pl fails the build above 0.15% pixel difference from approved screenshots.
- **End-to-End Ownership:** Run discovery with business owners, UI/UX, frontend, backend, self-managed VPS deployment (Docker, Dokploy), SEO and performance for bilingual PL/EN sites.

ready2order | Vienna, Austria / Remote 08/2019 - 12/2025
Frontend Software Engineer

- **Performance:** Cut the production bundle by 50% for faster load times by rewriting the legacy Webpack configuration, adding code splitting and dead-code elimination, and replacing Redux with the Apollo Client cache, React Context and local state.
- **Feature Modules:** Built modules from the ground up for a business-critical POS and business management SaaS, including CashBook, in React, TypeScript, Apollo GraphQL and Tailwind CSS, turning wireframes and prototypes into responsive UI.
- **Apollo Client Mentor:** Introduced correct use of the normalized cache and cache invalidation in place of server state managed by hand in Redux and redux-saga.
- **Markup and Styling Owner:** Was the frontend's main owner of CSS and semantic HTML5 practice - set the conventions, reviewed markup and styling quality, and helped migrate styling from Styled-components to Tailwind CSS and later CSS Modules.
- **Backend and Testing:** Extended the GraphQL API behind my features in PHP and Laravel with MySQL, using the ORM and plain SQL where needed; led code reviews and tested with Jest, React Testing Library and Cypress in a Scrum team.

Freelance | Remote 2016 - 2025
Web Developer (Independent)

- **Websites:** Built and launched websites for small businesses, alongside full-time work from 2019.
- **Booking Platform:** Improved a private booking platform with new search components, a pre-booking module and prices in search results, increasing user engagement; designed app prototypes in Adobe XD.

EDUCATION

University of Economics, Cracow 10/2016 - 09/2019
Bachelor of Applied Informatics, Software Engineering

- Built and maintained the Science-IT Club (KNI) website.

PROJECTS

- **Airchos (in development):** Quality-gate harness for AI coding agents - an agent cannot report done until deterministic checks pass, enforced at end of turn, commit, CI and deploy, the same way in Claude Code and Codex.
- **Kontor (private, early development):** Commerce engine as a Payload plugin with quotes, a configurable order lifecycle, a payments ledger with partial payments and an inventory ledger with reservations; built spec-driven with ADRs.
- **Payload Plugins:** payload-plugin-aspect-preview (open source on npm) for image cropping, focal points and responsive aspect-ratio previews; payload-plugin-map, a Leaflet location picker portable across PostgreSQL, SQLite and MongoDB.
- **Home Automation (IoT):** Self-hosted Home Assistant with five custom dashboards visualising time-series energy data in ApexCharts; rebuilt a Creality K1 3D printer with rewired electronics and Klipper firmware macros.

LANGUAGES

Polish (Native), English (Fluent), German (Basic, A2)